You're missing out!

Sign up for our weekly newsletter to learn about hackathons, community updates, and awesome projects.

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Participate in our public hackathons

Hackathons → Projects →

Devpost for Teams

Access your company's private hackathons

Login →

Host a hackathon

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Grow your developer ecosystem and promote your platform

Host a public hackathon →

Devpost for Teams

Drive innovation, collaboration, and retention within your organization

Host an internal hackathon →

By use case

AI hackathons → Customer hackathons → Employee hackathons → Public hackathons →

Resources

Blog

Insights into hackathon planning and participation

Customer stories

Inspiration from peers and other industry leaders

Planning guides

Best practices for planning online and in-person hackathons

Webinars & events

Upcoming events and on-demand recordings

Help desk

Common questions and support documentation

- DEVPOST
- Join a hackathon
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- Devpost

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Descend

- Overview
- My projects
- Participants (109)
- Resources
- Rules
- Project gallery
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AI Hackathon 2026 by LA Hacks

AI Hackathon 2026 by LA Hacks - apply now at ai.lahacks.com!

Start project
Find teammates
Import from portfolio

Who can participate

- Visit ai.lahacks.com to learn more and apply!
- Above legal age of majority in country of residence
- College students only
- All countries/territories, excluding standard exceptions

View full rules

23 more hours to deadline

View schedule

Deadline

Oct 18, 2026 @ 12:00pm PDT

- Apple
- Google
- Outlook

James West Alumni Center
Invite only
$25,021,600 in cash
109 participants

LA Hacks

Machine Learning/AI

LA Hacks is excited to announce our AI Hackathon, on campus at UCLA this Fall. Our team is excited to welcome participants, mentors, and sponsors back to Los Angeles to learn, develop, and innovate on this journey. Building on the success of our recent in-person hackathon, we are thrilled to carry this momentum forward and create a space for hackers to set the course for the next generation of innovation.

For mentors, judges, or sponsors, feel free to reach the team at ai.lahacks.com! Our event is unable to happen without you, and we greatly appreciate your efforts.

For Hackers: Everyone must apply at https://ai.lahacks.com/, be accepted, RSVP'ed, and attend in person to participate.

Requirements

What to Build

To submit, your project must align with one of these tracks and demonstrate innovative use of technology to solve real-world challenges. We encourage you to think big, build creatively, and push the boundaries of what's possible!

What to Submit

Your submission must include:

- **Project Description:** A brief explanation of what your project does, the problem it solves, and which track it falls under. How does it apply to the company challenges you submitted to?
- **Code Repository:** A public GitHub repository (or equivalent) containing your source code. Ensure it's well-documented.
- **Demo Video (2-3 min):** A walkthrough of your project, showcasing its features, functionality, and how it works.
- **Devpost Submission:** A complete Devpost page with a clear summary, technologies used, and any additional resources (e.g., Figma designs, API docs).

Make sure your submission is original, adheres to the hackathon rules, and is completed within the hackathon timeframe!

In order to be judged and eligible for prizes, you must be present in person for the judging phase of the hackathon!

Hackathon Sponsors

Prizes

$25,021,600+ in prizes
+ other prizes

To Be Determined

1 winner

To Be Determined - please stay up to date at ai.lahacks.com!

[MLH] Best Use of ElevenLabs

1 winner

Wireless Earbuds ||
Deploy natural, human-sounding audio with ElevenLabs. Create realistic, dynamic, and emotionally expressive voices for any project, from interactive AI companions to narrated stories and voice-enabled apps. ElevenLabs will empower you to build rich, immersive experiences without the need for actors or complex audio production, using simply the power of AI.

Integrate fully autonomous audio experiences into your hack with ElevenLabs and give your project a voice, along with giving your team the chance to win some wireless earbuds!

[MLH] Best Use of Gemini API

1 winner

MLH Swag Kits ||
It's time to push the boundaries of what's possible with AI using Google Gemini. Check out the Gemini API to build AI-powered apps that make your friends say WHOA. So, what can Gemini do for your hackathon project?

Understand language like a human and build a chatbot that gives personalized advice
Analyze info like a supercomputer and create an app that summarizes complex research papers
Generate creative content like code, scripts, music, and more
Think of the possibilities… what will you build with the Google Gemini API this weekend?

[MLH] Best Use of Solana

1 winner

Unruggable Hardware Wallets ||
The world of development is evolving fast and Solana is leading the charge with a network built to handle all of your

infrastructure needs. Forget high fees and slow confirmations, it's time to build applications that are fast, efficient, and scalable.

Harness Solana's core advantages like blazing fast execution and near-zero transaction costs to make your hackathon ideas become real world projects. With Solana, the possibilities are endless.

Create a game, social app, or consumer product that relies on instant, high-frequency transactions.
Design a sophisticated trading, lending, or decentralized exchange (DEX).
Build a prototype for supply chain, identity, or payments that can handle massive, real-world volume.
Show us how you can innovate with Solana for a chance to win Unruggable Hardware Wallets for you and each member of your team!

[MLH] Best Use of Tiger Data

1 winner

Stream Deck Mini ||
Building high-performance apps under hackathon deadlines shouldn't mean spending half your weekend configuring complex databases or learning obscure query languages. Tiger Data extends PostgreSQL to give student developers an ultra-fast foundation for real-time data, time-series metrics, and complex analytics.

Why build with Tiger Data this weekend?

Standard SQL Power: Query massive datasets instantly using the SQL you already know, with no complex NoSQL aggregation pipelines required.

Unified Data Stack: Store relational user profiles and high-frequency metric streams side-by-side in a single database.

Instant Dashboards: Serve lag-free, real-time frontend charts using pre-computed Continuous Aggregates.

90%+ Data Compression: Store millions of events on free-tier cloud instances without running out of disk space.

Whether you're building real-time IoT monitoring, AI-driven analytics dashboards, or financial prediction engines, show us how Tiger Data powers your project. The team that demonstrates the most innovative, impactful, and performance-driven use of Tiger Data will take home some great prizes!

[MLH] Best Use of Vultr

1 winner

M5Stack Official Tab5 ||
Vultr empowers hackers to bring their high-performance projects to life instantly; providing everything from the speed of one-click deployment and scalable cloud compute, to specialized Vultr Cloud GPUs that can power AI-driven applications. We want you to push the limits of what can be built when infrastructure is no longer the bottleneck!

Sign up for a Vultr account today and claim your free cloud credits! Take your next hack to the cloud with Vultr for a chance to win some awesome prizes for you and your team!

[MLH] Commit Fellowship Prize Category

1 winner

An Interview with the Commit Fellowship Team & a copy of The Lean Startup ||
Done sitting on your big idea? Enter the Commit Fellowship Prize Category to take your hack beyond the hackathon. Selected winning teams will have the chance to secure a spot in an exclusive, 3-week zero-to-founder sprint hosted by Major League Hacking and Transcend Network. If you're ready to do the real work of bringing a startup to market, this is for you.

Exclusive Admission: A chance to interview for the highly selective Commit Fellowship 3-week sprint.

Founder Mentorship: Live coaching, peer code reviews, and structured customer discovery sessions.

Launch Perks & Microgrants: Completion opens access to thousands of dollars in cash microgrants and in-kind tooling credits (like AI credits) to keep your post-hackathon momentum going.

Qualify by building a working prototype with a team, demonstrate a real problem worth solving, and opt into the Commit Fellowship Prize Category when you submit your project. Once that's complete, be sure to submit this supplemental form to be considered for the prize category. A winning team from your hackathon will be selected post-event and notified via email.

[MLH] Best Use of Snowflake API

1 winner

Arduino Student Kit ||
Play with industry-leading LLMs on a single account using the Snowflake APIs. Adding AI capabilities into your application can be as simple as a single CURL command to Snowflake's REST API.

Build customized applications, RAG powered chat bots, or embed AI-powered features into your app in half the time with half the hassle. Get started for free with a special, student 120-day Snowflake trial and check out this repository for an example of the Snowflake REST API in action.

[MLH] Best Domain Name from GoDaddy Registry

1 winner

Digital Gift Card ||
GoDaddy Registry is giving you everything you need to be the best hacker no matter where you are. Register your domain name with GoDaddy Registry for a chance to win some amazing prizes!

veri.studio

$800 in cash
1 winner

split among team

Visa - The Future of Shopping: Powered by AI, Secured by Visa

$2,000 in cash
1 winner

Cognition - Best Use of Devin

$5,000 in cash
5,000 winners

Fetch.ai - Best use of Fetch.ai

$3,000 in cash
1 winner

Espressif - Best Use of Espressif

1 winner

1st Place: Espressif M5StackChan, 2nd Place: ESP-VoCat, 3rd Place: Espressif M5Stack Stopwatch. Use Espressif hardware in your project.

Base44 - Build Something People Want

$2,000 in cash
1 winner

QNX - Best use of QNX

$1,500 in cash
1 winner

Creao AI - Build a Product Where the Agent Does the Work

$3,500 in cash
1 winner

Workday - Build the Future of Work with AI Challenge

$2,000 in cash
1 winner

Paper - Best Designed Hack

$3,000 in cash
1 winner

Even Realities - Smart Glasses Building Challenge

$3,800 in cash
1 winner

Devpost Achievements

Submitting to this hackathon could earn you:



X Hackathons

↑ level 2



Hackathon Winner

↑ level 1

Judges



LA Hacks Judges

Judging Criteria

- **Technical Depth**
  How technically sophisticated is the project? We look for clear engineering effort, thoughtful system design, and meaningful technical implementation. Does the team go beyond simple integrations or templates to demonstrate real technical understanding?
- **Product Thinking & Impact**
  Does the team clearly understand the problem and the user? Strong projects show thoughtful product design, a clear use case, and a believable real-world impact.
- **Execution & Polish**
  How well was the idea executed during the hackathon? Judges look for working functionality, a smooth demo, and a cohesive product experience.
- **Originality & Insight**
  Does the project present a fresh idea or perspective? We look for creative thinking, clever implementations, or unique insights that make the project stand out.

You're registered for this hackathon.

Unregister ✖ Edit registration questions ✎

×

Are you sure you want to unregister from AI Hackathon 2026 by LA Hacks?

Yes, unregister me from this hackathon Cancel

Questions? Email the hackathon manager

Invite others to compete

-

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